

MIRIYALA DURGA RAO

WAF & Application Security Engineer | Network Security

Hyderabad, India | +91 63026 71030 | miriyala.durgarao.career@gmail.com | Immediate Joiner
[linkedin.com/in/miriyala-durgarao](https://www.linkedin.com/in/miriyala-durgarao) | mdurgarao-tech.github.io | github.com/mdurgarao-tech

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

WAF and Application Security Engineer with 6+ years of cybersecurity experience protecting enterprise web applications and APIs, including 4 years of hands-on Imperva WAF experience. Skilled across Imperva, Akamai, AWS WAF, Azure WAF, Cloudflare and FortiWeb — WAF policy design, managed and custom rule tuning, OWASP Top 10 protection, API security, bot mitigation, rate limiting and false-positive reduction. Backed by strong network security depth: Zscaler ZIA/ZPA, Palo Alto, Fortinet, Check Point, Cisco ASA and F5 LTM. Comfortable with HTTP/HTTPS, TLS/SSL, DNS, reverse proxy, SIEM integration, incident response and automation using Python, Bash and Ansible.

CORE SKILLS

WAF & Application Security: Imperva WAF, Akamai WAF/CDN, AWS WAF, Azure WAF, Cloudflare, FortiWeb, WAF policy design, managed/custom rules, OWASP Top 10 (SQLi, XSS, CSRF, RCE, LFI/RFI, SSRF), L7 DDoS, bot mitigation, credential stuffing, rate limiting, IP reputation, geo/ASN blocking, API protection, false-positive reduction, staged enforcement

Network & Zero Trust: Zscaler ZIA/ZPA/ZTNA, Palo Alto/Panorama, Fortinet/FortiManager, Check Point, Cisco ASA, F5 LTM, FireMon, Blue Coat ProxySG, IPSec/SSL VPN, NAT, HA

Monitoring & Automation: Splunk, Microsoft Sentinel, ELK, WAF log analysis, incident response, RCA, ServiceNow, Python, PowerShell, Bash, Ansible, Terraform, Git/GitHub Actions, Jenkins, Azure DevOps, Regex, JSON/YAML

Cloud & Protocols: AWS (VPC, IAM, Security Groups, NACL), Azure, HTTP/HTTPS, TLS/SSL, DNS, REST APIs, reverse proxy, CDN, Wireshark, tcpdump

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

WAF & Network Security Engineer (C2H) — High Noon Consulting | Client: Deloitte USI, Hyderabad *Jul 2026 – Sep 2026*

- Managed day-to-day WAF operations across Imperva, Akamai, AWS WAF, Cloudflare and FortiWeb for globally distributed enterprise applications, tuning managed and custom rulesets against OWASP Top 10 and Layer 7 attacks including SQLi, XSS, CSRF, RCE and path traversal.
- Onboarded new applications and REST APIs to WAF platforms end to end — defined protection policies, set up API security rules and schema validation, and coordinated staged production cutovers with application, DevOps and SRE teams to avoid service disruption.
- Configured bot mitigation, rate limiting and IP-reputation controls to counter credential stuffing and volumetric L7 abuse, tuning thresholds and challenge actions to block malicious traffic while keeping impact on legitimate users to a minimum.
- Ran cloud-native WAF security audits for Azure-hosted applications, covering policy review, rule validation, WAF log analysis and false-positive reduction, and documented findings with remediation steps for security leads and application owners.
- Executed managed ruleset version upgrades (e.g. 2.1 to 2.2) in a controlled manner, validating rule behaviour in detection mode before enforcement and partnering with app owners to close audit findings against web application protection standards.
- Triaged WAF-related incidents and change requests through ServiceNow, performing root-cause analysis on blocked-traffic and false-positive tickets and coordinating fixes with the relevant application teams.
- Automated recurring WAF configuration, backup, validation and reporting tasks using Python and Ansible, reducing manual effort and improving consistency across platforms.

Network Security Engineer — Unizen Technologies Pvt Ltd, Bangalore *Nov 2025 – Mar 2026*

- Managed Zscaler ZIA and ZPA operations including traffic forwarding, SSL inspection, URL filtering and Zero Trust access policies for internal and remote users.
- Performed security policy changes, NAT configuration, rule optimization and high-availability operations across Palo Alto and Fortinet firewall environments, following change-management processes.
- Reviewed and cleaned up firewall rulebases to remove redundant, shadowed and overly permissive rules, improving policy hygiene and audit readiness.

Cybersecurity Consultant — LTIMindtree Limited, Hyderabad *May 2025 – Oct 2025*

- Implemented and maintained Zscaler security controls across ZIA and ZPA, and supported Palo Alto, Fortinet and Check Point firewall operations for enterprise clients.
- Supported a Blue Coat ProxySG to Zscaler migration, including PAC file design, traffic-forwarding configuration, phased cutover and post-migration validation to confirm policy parity.

Network Security Analyst — Litehires Global Private Limited, Bangalore *Mar 2020 – Apr 2025*

- Managed Imperva WAF policies, custom rules, log analysis, false-positive reduction, IP reputation, geo-blocking, rate limiting and OWASP Top 10 protections for enterprise web applications across production environments.
- Tuned WAF rules using traffic baselining, exception handling and staged enforcement (detection before blocking) to balance strong security with a low false-positive rate across critical production applications.
- Investigated and resolved WAF alerts and blocked-traffic events, distinguishing genuine attacks from legitimate traffic and adjusting rules and signatures accordingly.
- Supported Akamai CDN application onboarding, cache configuration, validation and purge operations, along with DNS and SSL/TLS certificate troubleshooting for enterprise applications.
- Troubleshoot application-layer issues across HTTP/HTTPS traffic, DNS resolution, certificates, reverse proxy and end-to-end web application flows using tools such as Wireshark and browser developer tools.
- Supported 50+ firewalls and optimized 2,000+ rules using FireMon across Palo Alto, Fortinet, Check Point and Cisco ASA, improving rule efficiency and reducing policy risk.
- Worked with Zscaler and F5 LTM and supported AWS security controls including VPC, Security Groups, IAM and NACLs for cloud-hosted workloads.
- Used Python and Ansible for configuration automation, scheduled backups and recurring reporting, reducing manual operational overhead.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Imperva WAF Onboarding & Policy Tuning — Application onboarding, managed/custom rules, OWASP protection, log analysis and false-positive reduction across Imperva and AWS WAF.

Akamai CDN Application Delivery — CDN onboarding, DNS, TLS/SSL, cache validation and purge operations for enterprise applications.

Proxy-to-Zscaler Migration — PAC-based traffic forwarding, cutover and validation from Blue Coat ProxySG to Zscaler.

Firewall Rule Optimization — FireMon-based review and cleanup of 2,000+ firewall rules across a multi-vendor firewall environment.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

- B.Tech, Computer Science & Engineering — KKR & KSR Institute of Technology & Sciences (KITS), Guntur (JNTU Kakinada), 2019
- CCNA — Certified | PCNSE — In Progress

LANGUAGES

English — Professional | Telugu — Native | Hindi — Proficient